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Minister of Culture, Tourism and Development of N-E Region

ANI

WHAT'S DONE

- 600 gurus, 4,800 artists, 800 cultural outfits given financial support in 2021-22
- Apart from the Prime Ministers' Museum, eight other museums set up
- 40 cultural events held in eight countries in 2021

CHALLENGE AHEAD

- The ministry, with the help of experts, is working on an inclusive model to make museums more informative and entertaining

CULTURE

THE MINISTRY OF CULTURE is meant to preserve India's cultural heritage and promote art and culture through archaeological sites, museums and public libraries; promotion and dissemination of performing arts; Buddhist and Tibetan studies; international cultural relations and construction of cultural complexes.
The budgetary allocation for the ministry's flagship Kala Sanskriti Vikas Yojana, through which cultural organisations and individuals are given financial assistance, has gone up from Rs 122 crore in 2020-21 to Rs 186 crore this fiscal. Apart from the 6,011 existing beneficiaries, 1,800 new artists were provided with pension and medical aid last year. For the past one year, the ministry has been curating campaigns under the 'Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav', inaugurated by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in March 2021 as a countdown to the 75th anniversary of India's Independence. While the country has been busy debating the religious origin of various monuments, the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) has made 17 new additions to its list of protected monuments and sites, taking the total count to nearly 4,000. Till 2020-21, the seven Zonal Cultural Centres under the ministry—headquartered in Patiala, Nagpur, Udaipur, Prayagraj, Kolkata, Dimapur and Thanjavur—had revived 193 vanishing art forms. ■

DoNER

THE MINISTRY OF DEVELOPMENT OF NORTH EASTERN REGION (DoNER) is responsible for the planning, execution and monitoring of development schemes in the states of Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Sikkim and Tripura with a mandate to accelerate the socio-economic development of the region. The ministry got a massive thrust this year as a new scheme, the Prime Minister's Development Initiative for North East (PM-DevINE), with an initial allocation of Rs 1,500 crore, was announced in Union Budget 2022-23. The recent years have seen massive expansion of infrastructure projects in the Northeast. More than 20 projects, for nearly 2,000 km of railway lines, are under different stages of planning, approval and execution. Road networks, totalling about 4,016 km, are also in the works while 3,099 km of roads have already been built in the past five years. Under the Northeast Council, 215 infrastructure projects worth Rs 1,267.4 crore were sanctioned between 2016-17 and 2020-21. Of these, 15 projects have been completed and 200 are being implemented. ■

WHAT'S DONE

- 28 air connectivity projects completed from 2016-17 to 2021-22; over 20 projects, covering 2,000 km of railway lines, in the works
- 530 proposals worth Rs 3,343 cr got nod under Northeast Industrial Development Scheme
- Dept for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade recognised 674 start-ups from region; NEDFi released Rs 41.14 cr to 22 start-ups

CHALLENGES AHEAD

- Expenditure under 10% spending on Northeast by Union ministries fell from Rs 48,533.8 cr in 2019-20 to Rs 38,455.5 cr in 2021-22
- Waterway projects need to be fast-tracked